

The Learning Studio

Content Guide

Importing the theme in WordPress Playground, and adding a Lesson, a Subject, and a Blog post - through the WordPress admin and through the JSON content pipeline.

Repository:

https://github.com/asammad48/the_learning_studio

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1. Importing the theme in WordPress Playground

Method A - One-click Blueprint (recommended)

WordPress Playground runs a full WordPress site in your browser, with no server or install needed. A Blueprint is a small JSON file that tells Playground what to set up automatically: install the theme, import the sample content, and configure Pages/menus/Reading settings.

1. Open <https://playground.wordpress.net/>
2. Click **Blueprint** in the toolbar, then paste the JSON below (or use the direct link at the end of this section).
3. Playground installs the theme straight from GitHub, imports every Subject/Lesson/Page/Post, and runs the setup wizard automatically.

Blueprint JSON (wordpress-theme/playground-blueprint.json)

```
{
  "$schema": "https://playground.wordpress.net/blueprint-schema.json",
  "landingPage": "/",
  "steps": [
    {
      "step": "installTheme",
      "themeData": {
        "resource": "git:directory",
        "url": "https://github.com/asammad48/the_learning_studio",
        "ref": "main",
        "path": "wordpress-theme/the-learning-studio"
      },
      "options": {
        "activate": true
      }
    },
    {
      "step": "runPHP",
      "code": "<?php require_once '/wordpress/wp-load.php'; tls_import_json_content(
get_stylesheet_directory() . '/legacy-data', false, false ); tls_run_site_setup( true,
true, true );"
    }
  ]
}
```

What each step does:

- `installTheme` with a `git:directory` resource pulls just the theme subfolder out of the repo (a monorepo) and activates it - no build step needed.
- `runPHP` calls two theme functions directly: `tls\_import\_json\_content()` (imports Subjects, Lessons, Pages, and Posts from `legacy-data/`) and `tls\_run\_site\_setup()` (creates the required Pages, builds and assigns the 4 navigation menus, and configures Reading settings).

>> Click to open this Blueprint directly in WordPress Playground

Method B - Manual theme upload

Use this on a real WordPress site, or if you would rather control each step by hand.

1. Build the theme zip: ``python scripts/build_wordpress_theme.py`` (produces ``dist/the-learning-studio-1.0.0.zip``).
2. In wp-admin: **Appearance -> Themes -> Add New Theme -> Upload Theme**, choose the zip, then **Activate**.
3. Go to **Tools -> Learning Studio Setup**. Check the boxes you want (reassign menus / configure Reading settings), then **Run setup**. This creates the required Pages (Home, Subjects, Blog, About, Contact, Privacy, Terms) and the 4 navigation menus.
4. Go to **Tools -> Learning Studio Import**. Leave **Dry run** checked first to preview, then uncheck it and run for real. Check **Update existing** only if you want re-imports to overwrite content that already exists.

WP-CLI alternative

```
wp tls import --source=/absolute/path/to/the_learning_studio --dry-run --update-existing
```

Drop the dry-run flag to write for real; drop the update-existing flag to only create new content and leave existing content untouched.

2. Adding a Lesson

Through the WordPress admin

1. Go to **Lessons -> Add New Lesson**.
2. **Title:** the lesson's title, e.g. "What Is Project Management?"
3. **Content editor:** the full lesson body.
4. **Excerpt:** a one to two sentence summary shown on lesson cards (enable the Excerpt panel from Screen Options if it is hidden).
5. **Featured Image:** set in the sidebar - shown on cards and the lesson page.
6. **Subjects** panel (sidebar): check the Subject this lesson belongs to.
7. **Lesson Details** box (sidebar):
 - **Lesson format** - Written lesson / Video lesson / Video + written lesson
 - **Duration / read time** - free text, e.g. "6 min read"
 - **YouTube URL** - a normal youtube.com/watch?v=... link; the theme embeds it automatically
 - **Feature this lesson** - shows it in the homepage Featured Lessons section
 - **Featured order priority** - higher numbers appear first among featured lessons
8. **Quick Quiz** box (main column): click **Add question** for each question/answer pair. A row only saves once both fields are filled; visitors reveal the answer by clicking the question on the lesson page.
9. Click **Publish**.

Through the JSON pipeline (source of truth)

This is how the theme's sample content is built, and how bulk or repeatable content should be added. It keeps the static site and the WordPress import in sync from one file.

1. Edit `data/lessons.json` - append an object (or run `python scripts/content\_manager.py` and choose "Add lesson / blog post / video").
2. **Important:** the `subject` field must equal the associated Subject's `category` field, not its `name`. `subjectSlug` must match the Subject's `slug`.
3. Copy the same entry into `wordpress-theme/the-learning-studio/legacy-data/lessons.json` so the two files stay byte-identical.
4. Run `python scripts/build\_site.py` to regenerate the static HTML pages.
5. Run `python scripts/build\_wordpress\_theme.py` to rebuild the theme zip with the updated `legacy-data`.
6. Import into WordPress via **Tools -> Learning Studio Import**, `wp tls import`, or the Playground blueprint from Part 1.

Real example - data/lessons.json

```
{
  "slug": "what-is-project-management",
  "title": "What Is Project Management?",
  "subject": "Business & Management",
  "subjectSlug": "project-management",
  "duration": "6 min read",
  "featured": false,
  "excerpt": "The five stages every project moves through, from initiation to closure, and why scope, time and cost stay in constant tension.",
  "body": [
    "Project management is the discipline of planning, organizing and overseeing a temporary piece of work with a clear start and end, until it delivers a defined outcome.",
    "Most projects move through five stages: initiation, planning, execution, monitoring and closure. Initiation confirms the project is worth doing, planning sets the schedule, budget and resources, execution is where the work actually happens, monitoring tracks progress against the plan, and closure confirms the deliverable is complete and hands it over.",
    "Every project manager balances the same three constraints: scope, time and cost. Pulling on one, such as adding features, shortening the deadline or cutting the budget, puts pressure on the other two, which is why realistic planning matters as much as steady execution."
  ],
  "quiz": [
    {
      "question": "What are the three constraints a project manager must balance?",
      "answer": "Scope, time and cost"
    }
  ]
}
```

3. Adding a Subject

Through the WordPress admin

1. Go to **Lessons -> Subjects -> Add New Subject**.
2. **Name:** e.g. "Project Management". The **Slug** auto-generates from the name, or set it manually.
3. **Description:** shown on the subject's card and its archive page.
4. **Subject group:** groups related subjects together on the **/subjects/** directory page, e.g. "Business & Management".
5. **Image:** click **Select image** to choose or upload from the Media Library, or set a **Fallback image URL** for when no Media Library image is chosen.
6. **Featured subject:** shows it in the homepage Featured Subjects section.
7. **Featured order priority:** higher numbers appear first among featured subjects.
8. Click **Add New Subject**.

Through the JSON pipeline

1. Edit `data/subjects.json` - append an object (or run `python scripts/content_manager.py` and choose "Add subject").
2. `category` becomes both the Subject group shown on the directory page, and the value every associated Lesson's `subject` field must match.
3. `lessons` is a manually maintained display count, not auto-computed from real Lesson entries.
4. `image` is an absolute site path, e.g. `/assets/generated/subjects/your-slug.png`. Generate on-brand cover images with `python scripts/generate_cover_images.py`, or point it at any image already under `/assets/`.
5. Copy the entry into `wordpress-theme/the-learning-studio/legacy-data/subjects.json`, then rebuild and import exactly as with Lessons.

Real example - data/subjects.json

```
{
  "slug": "project-management",
  "name": "Project Management",
  "category": "Business & Management",
  "lessons": 1,
  "featured": false,
  "description": "Planning, scheduling and delivering projects on time, on budget and within scope.",
  "image": "/assets/generated/subjects/project-management.png"
}
```


4. Adding a Blog post

Blog posts are genuine WordPress Posts (`post_type=post`) - a separate content type from Lessons. The **Blog** menu link is WordPress's own Posts page.

Through the WordPress admin

1. Go to **Posts -> Add New**.
2. **Title** and the **content editor** for the post body.
3. **Excerpt**: a short summary shown on the Blog listing.
4. **Featured Image**: the cover shown on the Blog listing and the single post page.
5. **Categories / Tags** panel (sidebar): assign existing ones or create new ones inline.
6. Click **Publish**.

Through the JSON pipeline

1. Edit `data/posts.json` (optional file - older imports without it still work).
2. `categories` and `tags` are arrays of plain names; the importer creates them if they do not already exist.
3. `image` (optional) is copied into the Media Library and set as the real featured image on import - a plain URL is not enough for Posts, since `has_post_thumbnail()` needs a real attachment.
4. Copy the entry into `wordpress-theme/the-learning-studio/legacy-data/posts.json`, then import via **Tools -> Learning Studio Import**, `wp tls import`, or the Playground blueprint.

Note: the static (non-WordPress) site does not have a separate blog-post concept - its **/blog/** page lists every Lesson instead. `posts.json` is WordPress-only.

Real example - data/posts.json

```
{
  "slug": "why-we-built-the-learning-studio",
  "title": "Why We Built The Learning Studio",
  "excerpt": "Most online courses are either too shallow to be useful or too long to finish.
    We wanted something in between.",
  "body": [
    "We kept running into the same problem: free explainers online were often too shallow to actually build understanding, while full courses demanded a ten-hour commitment before you even knew if the subject was for you. There was very little in between - nothing built for someone who wanted a real, working grasp of a topic in the time it takes to read a few pages.",
    "So The Learning Studio is built around a single unit: one lesson, one subject, one sitting. Each lesson is short enough to finish on a coffee break but written to leave you with an actual working understanding, not just a list of definitions you will forget by the next morning.",
    "We are starting with business, technology, health, finance, marketing and a handful of other subjects, and we are adding more as we go. If there is a topic you wish existed here, that feedback is exactly what shapes what we build next."
  ],
  "categories": [
    "Announcements"
  ],
  "tags": [
    "about",
    "mission"
  ],
  "image": "/assets/generated/posts/why-we-built-the-learning-studio.png"
}
```

5. Reference and links

Links

Repository: https://github.com/asammad48/the_learning_studio

Theme folder: https://github.com/asammad48/the_learning_studio/tree/main/wordpress-theme/the-learning-studio

Playground blueprint file: https://github.com/asammad48/the_learning_studio/blob/main/wordpress-theme/playground-blueprint.json

WordPress Playground: <https://playground.wordpress.net/>

>> [One-click import link \(Playground Blueprint\)](#)

Admin screens

- **Tools -> Learning Studio Setup** - Pages, menus, Reading settings
- **Tools -> Learning Studio Import** - imports data/*.json content
- **Lessons -> All Lessons / Lessons -> Subjects**
- **Posts -> All Posts** - Blog posts
- **Appearance -> Customize** - hero, panel, subjects/lessons section controls

Useful commands

```
python scripts/content_manager.py          # interactive content editor
python scripts/build_site.py               # rebuild the static site
python scripts/build_wordpress_theme.py    # rebuild the theme zip
python scripts/generate_cover_images.py    # regenerate on-brand images
wp tls import --source=<path> [--dry-run] [--update-existing]
```